



Forgotten icons: The 1990s-born quartet of Stefanos Tsitsipas, Daniil Medvedev, Alexander Zverev, and the retired Dominic Thiem — dismissively dubbed the ‘lost generation’ and ‘sandwich generation’ — were trampled by the Big Three, and now ambushed by the even more formidable new Big Two, or humbled by newcomers.



Djokovic’s **(left)** bid for an eighth Wimbledon title to equal Federer’s record ended in the semis against Sinner, whom P-Mac described as “a younger, more powerful version of the GOAT”. Sinner was also healthier, as his elbow had recovered, while Djokovic’s movement was compromised by an injured hip. Aside from a short-lived 3-0 lead in the third set, neither his vast experience nor chants of “Nole! Nole!” could save Djokovic from a decisive 6-3, 6-3, 6-4 defeat.

“Grass will always be Sinner’s toughest surface [to master],” opined John McEnroe, the former three-time Wimbledon champion, before the final. The ambitious Italian worked hard to improve his movement, particularly to reach and hit open-stance backhands on the dead run, but also to sprint to the net to retrieve the Spaniard’s drop shots.

Alcaraz had won their last five matches, but Sinner proved too powerful and efficient to lose again. With Sinner facing set point at 4-5, the two young rivals engaged in one of their finest power rallies. Alcaraz made two amazing gets, the second when he slid 10 feet and ended up outside the alley to conjure a geometry-defying forehand cross-court. The more agile Spaniard then countered the Italian’s weaker return, flicking a backhand cross-court winner into the open court. With an unreturnable 137-mph serve — his fastest of the match — Sinner prevailed 4-6, 6-4, 6-4, 6-4 to become the first Italian to win a Wimbledon singles crown.

It also left no doubt about the widening gulf between the Big Two and their supposed competition. All too often in 2025, the rest of the men’s field seemed like mere appetisers before the main course: the almost inevitable Sincaraz final. Where did all the presumptive contenders go? The 1990s-born quartet of Stefanos Tsitsipas, Medvedev, Zverev, and the retired Dominic Thiem